

Supplement to: An Inception Cohort Study Quantifying How Many Registered Studies are Published.

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This supplement provides additional details on the classification of registrations as research studies or not, the classification of studies as published or not, the calculations to extrapolate from our sample to the population of registrations on the OSF before November 2017, additional analyses about how extensive registrations were, and a more fine-grained overview of reasons researchers provided not to publish their study.

Details on Classifying Registrations as a Research Study

It can be challenging to determine whether a registration was performed with the goal to publish a study. Sometimes, the description of the registration or project page explicitly revealed that a registration was not an actual research study (for instance, when the group number of the course was shared), or it explicitly linked to a final publication. When it was not clear from the description on the OSF if the registration concerned an actual research study, we searched for information about the researcher(s) on the OSF. If the person who registered the project had various activity points and projects on the OSF, we assumed this person was an active researcher, and not a student. If someone had used the OSF at most a few times since 2017, and did not provide any personal information, we tried to determine if the user was a researcher by searching for scientific publications or membership of research groups (e.g. profiles on institutional websites). If such information could be found, the registration was coded as an actual research study. If such information could not be found, the registration was marked as “no research study” (e.g., it was assumed to be a student assignment). In the case of mul-

tiple researchers, it is possible that only a subgroup of the researchers could be found. If only one of the researchers seemed to be a real researcher, we assumed that the registration was part of a student project, where the researcher supervised the other users of the OSF. However, if more than one researcher seemed to be an actual researcher, the registration was marked as an actual research study. These decisions necessarily introduce some arbitrariness in whether a study was intended to be published or not, and therefore we explored whether researchers intended to publish a study when we emailed researchers to follow up on unpublished registrations (see below). As we did not email researchers when we felt confident the registration was not a research study, and as we did not receive replies from all researchers we emailed, the final classification has remaining uncertainty (see the discussion).

Details on Extrapolating to the Population

Before emailing authors, we believed 71 articles remained unpublished. We received responses for 45 registrations after emailing researchers, and we did not get a response for 26 registrations. Based on these responses we learned that out of all registrations we thought were unpublished 14 were actually published, and 31 remained unpublished. We will compute the probability that a paper is published, even though we believed it was unpublished both for registrations classified as automatically opened (28 out of 45), and manually opened (17 out of 45).

Of the 14 registrations researchers informed us were actually published, 6 were from registrations classified as automatically opened (out of 28 automatically opened registrations that we received a response for), so 6/28 registrations classified as automatically opened that we thought were unpublished were actually published. For the registrations classified as manually opened, 8 out of 17 were published.

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We can use these two percentages to extrapolate to the 26 registrations we did not get a response to our email for. Of these 26, 22 were classified as automatically opened, and 4 were classified as manually opened, for which the following might hold. 8/16 of the 4 manually opened registrations could be published (which equals 1.88 published registrations), and 6/28 of the 22 automatically opened registrations could be published (which equals $0.21 * 22 = 4.71$ registrations). So an additional 6.60 registrations should be considered published, and 19.40 remain unpublished.

We can repeat these extrapolations for the registrations we were uncertain about. We were uncertain about 30 registrations (often due to a lack of information in the registration). Of those we got a reply for 24. For the 24 registrations we were uncertain about that we did receive a response for, 12 are published, and 12 are not. For the manually opened projects, 3 out of 5 were published, and for the automatically opened projects 9 out of 19 were published. Of the 6 registrations we did not receive a reply for, 1 was manually opened, and 5 were automatically opened. So on average $3/5 * 1 = 0.60$ registrations classified as manually opened will be published, and $9/19 * 5 = 2.37$ registrations classified as automatically opened will be published, for a total of 2.97.

Altogether, for automatically opened registrations the percentage of published studies is 6 we classified as published, 6 registrations we thought were unpublished, but through email responses learned were published, 9 we were originally uncertain about but were confirmed unpublished in an email response, 2.37 for the 5 we initially were unsure about but were predicted to be published had researchers replied to our emails, and the 4.71 we initially thought were unpublished but were predicted to be published had researchers replied to our emails, for a total of 28.08 published automatically opened articles out of a total of 80 (35.10%).

For automatically opened registrations the percentage of published studies is 62 we classified as published, 8 registrations we thought were unpublished, but through email responses learned were published, 3 we were originally uncertain about but were confirmed unpublished in an email response, 0.60 we initially were unsure about but were predicted to be published had researchers replied to our emails, and the 1.88 we initially thought were unpublished but were predicted to be published had researchers replied to our emails, for a total of 75.48 published manually opened articles out of a total of 89.00 (84.81%).

These two estimated percentages of the number of published studies in the registrations classified as manually opened and automatically opened are used in Table 3 in the main document to extrapolate from our sample to the number of published articles in the entire population of registrations we retrieved from the OSF up to November 2017.

Extensiveness of Information in Registrations

We observed quite some variation in the amount of detail in the registrations that we examined. We therefore decided to code the extensiveness of the registrations based on the information written in the registration (but not in any associated files, such as uploaded text documents). We labeled all registrations that were empty as 1 (which means it was not clear what the study was about based on the registration) and all registrations that had a minimal description as 2 (this means either a detailed title or small remark about the content of the study was included). If there was a somewhat more detailed but short description about the study, the registration was coded as 3 and finally, all registrations that included a detailed description were coded as 4. In this way, we could compare the quality of the registrations in both groups and check for possible differences that could lead to different publication rates. 19% of all registrations in the manually opened registrations and 15% of all registrations in the automatically opened registration were empty, so that it was not clear what the goal or topic of the study was purely based on the registration. At least a minimal description was given for 36% of the registrations in the manually opened registrations and 29% in the automatically opened registration, meaning that although very brief, there were some details about the content of the study (e.g., a descriptive title). A more detailed short description was provided in 10% of the cases in the manually opened registrations and 8% of the cases in the automatically opened registration. Finally, most registrations seem to fall in the last group of extensive registrations (36% and 49% in the manually opened registrations and the automatically opened registration, respectively). These results are summarized in Table 1. The fact that similar percentages are found in manually opened registrations and the automatically opened registration shows that the level of detail in the registrations does not differ substantially between the two groups. Therefore, the difference in probability that we found a registration that was classified as manually opened, compared to classifications that were automatically opened, is not explained by a difference in the level of detail of the registrations.

Fine-Grained Categorization of Reasons for Non-Publication

In the main text we have classified the reasons that researchers provided to not publish their registered study in five categories. Below in Table 2 we provide a more fine-grained classification consisting of 15 categories.

Table 1
Classification of the extensiveness of registrations.

	Empty	Minimal	Short	Extensive
Manually Opened	17	32	9	32
Automatically Opened	12	23	6	39

Table 2
Summary of main reasons researchers self-reported to not publish registered studies.

	Manually Opened	Automatically Opened	Total
No significant results	2	5	7
Left academia	4	4	8
Paper rejected	6	2	8
Failed replication	1	3	4
Unfinished study	1	6	7
Educational project	1	3	4
Pilot	0	1	1
Switched job / research directions	0	3	3
Shared with funder (not the goal to publish)	0	1	1
Lack of time / busy with other projects	2	4	6
Conflicting / unclear results	0	3	3
Flaws in procedure	1	2	3
Still in progress	1	1	2
Reviewers requested it	1	2	3
Extra study (no priority)	0	1	1
Health issues	0	1	1

Note. Only the first or main reason was coded whenever respondents gave multiple reasons.

Motivations for opening or not opening OSF project pages

We were also interested in the motivation to either make the associated OSF project public or keep it private. While most researchers (79%) mentioned a motivation to practice open science as the primary reason for opening an OSF project

(see Table 3), more diverse reasons were given for keeping the OSF project closed (see Table 4). Many researchers (36%) mentioned that the associated project does not contain any new or relevant information, so peers would not benefit if the project was opened. The second most common reason not to open the project (26%) was that researchers simply forgot. Others made the moment to open the project depen-

Table 3
Summary of main reasons researchers self-reported to open their OSF project page.

	Open Science	Technical Issues	Other
Reasons	18	2	3

Table 4
Summary of main reasons researchers self-reported to not open their OSF project page.

	Results	Publication Process	No New Information	Planning	Technical Issues	Forgotten	Other
Reasons	1	6	15	4	4	11	2

dent on the publication of the study (14%), and technical issues (e.g., a lack of familiarity or misunderstanding about the OSF) were reasons to both open a project and to keep it private (in 8% and 10% of the cases, respectively).

Researchers

Some researchers appeared in our database multiple times. This is an indication of the use of the OSF by early adopters in the years up to 2017. After excluding multiple registrations for the same research project, one researcher appeared three times, and three other researchers appeared two times. Although each registration can be published or not, there is the possibility of some dependencies in the data set because the probability that these authors publish a paper might be correlated across registrations.